Record Numbers

Each record is assigned an internal control number, known as a record number. Record numbers are prefixed with a period (.) and a one-character tag that identifies the record type. The record types are assigned the following character tags:

b	bibliographic
o	order
i	item
c	checkin
a	authority
p	patron
r	course
n	invoice
v	vendor
e	resource
l	license
t	contact
j	volume

Record numbers are seven or eight digits long, including a modulus 11 check digit in the last position. For example, the number **.b10243641** is interpreted as follows:

```
.b10243641
|||      |
|||      `--- Check digit
||`--- Record number
|`--- Record type (bibliographic)
`--- Record number prefix
```

Check Digits

Check digits may be any one of 11 possible digits (**0**, **1**, **2**, **3**, **4**, **5**, **6**, **7**, **8**, **9**, or **x**).

The check digit is calculated as follows:

1. Multiply the rightmost digit of the record number by 2, the next digit to the left by 3, the next by 4, etc., and total the products. For example:

```
1 0 2 4 3 6 4
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | 4 * 2 =  8
| | | | | 6 * 3   = 18
| | | | 3 * 4     = 12
| | | 4 * 5       = 20
| | 2 * 6         = 12
| 0 * 7           =  0
1 * 8             =  8
                    78
```

2. Divide the total by 11 and retain the remainder (for example, 78 / 11 is 7, with a remainder of 1). The remainder after the division is the check digit. If the remainder is 10, the letter **x** is used as the check digit.

When searching for a record number, if you don't know the check digit, you can substitute the character **a** for the check digit. For example, you could enter the record number above as **.b1024364a**.

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